

HOUSE BILL 1981

By Grills

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 4,
Chapter 1, Part 3, relative to designating Lake
County as the Eagle Capital of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, across human history, eagles have been revered as powerful symbols of strength, freedom, and vision, appearing on the flags, currency, and heraldry of dozens of nations; and

WHEREAS, eagles play a critical role in maintaining the balance of their ecosystems by regulating populations of prey species and scavenging on carrion; and

WHEREAS, Lake County has become a mecca for eagle enthusiasts, annually holding the Reelfoot Lake Eagle Festival, attracting bird watchers from far and wide; and

WHEREAS, with over ninety eagle nests in the area and thousands of migrating eagles coming to spend the winter months at Reelfoot Lake and along the Mississippi River in Lake County, eagles can be seen as they perch in trees along the banks of the lake and river and soar overhead in search of food; and

WHEREAS, Reelfoot Lake State Park and Reelfoot National Wildlife Refuge and private outfitters offer eagle tours during the months of January and February, providing a positive economic impact for Lake County from the many overnight visitations for eagle watching, photography, and tours; now, therefore,

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 4, Chapter 1, Part 3, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

Lake County is designated as the Eagle Capital of Tennessee.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.